

Zubair Oakhurst

Character Dossier

Charming and evasive tax collector of Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity

Overview

Zubair Oakhurst is a tax collector living in Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity. Zubair is 33 years old, originally from Oldbridge, and is known around the Undermarket as charming and evasive. In conversation Zubair answers a question with a question before giving a real answer.

Background

Zubair arrived in Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity 28 years ago after leaving Oldbridge under circumstances Zubair describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Halcyon Syndicate; the second was the one that stuck. Today Zubair works as a tax collector near Sector 9 transit hub and is paid, when paid at all, in meridian scrip.

Zubair learned the trade from Soren Ravensworth, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Zubair's life is with Marisol Ironside, over a matter neither will explain. The person Zubair trusts most is Olwen Brightmoor.

Current goal: to build a boat with no nails in it. Greatest fear: running out of salt.

Personality and speech

Temperament: charming and evasive.

Speech pattern: Zubair answers a question with a question before giving a real answer.

Tells: when lying, Zubair mentions Sprocket the owl for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

<i>Full name</i>	Zubair Oakhurst
<i>Role</i>	tax collector
<i>Home</i>	Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity
<i>Hometown</i>	Oldbridge
<i>Age</i>	33
<i>Favourite dish</i>	cold pickled plums
<i>Pet</i>	Sprocket, a owl
<i>Lucky number</i>	621

<i>Workshop password</i>	saffron-oak
<i>Mentor</i>	Soren Ravensworth
<i>Rival</i>	Marisol Ironside
<i>Closest friend</i>	Olwen Brightmoor

Secret

Zubair has a sibling nobody in Neon Meridian, a rain-soaked megacity knows about, living quietly in Oldbridge.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Zubair: I am the tax collector. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Zubair: Cold pickled plums. Do not tell Marisol I said so.

Visitor: Is Sprocket yours?

Zubair: Sprocket belongs to nobody. Sprocket tolerates me. Lucky number is 621, if you were about to ask.